



PROGRESS REPORT

Sao Tome and Principe: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-01 · 50 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY ·
INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-01.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	A National Strategy for Digital Governance adopted in 2020 runs on nine thematic axes, and a Public Administration Reform Strategy approved in 2025 names electronic governance its essential pillar. The digital governance strategy is a whole-of-government instrument on nine axes; the source page is undated and the year is taken from its context, so even the strategy's own date rests on inference (strategy). The reform strategy was presented as newly approved in June 2025 with electronic governance named as its essential pillar (reform). Neither carries a target, budget, milestone or review published anywhere the base can reach, so what either instrument commits the state to is unstated.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	A revision of the regulatory framework covering the regulatory entities law and the electronic communications law was approved by the Council of Ministers and sent to the National Assembly. The regulator's own statute was already approved, and the two laws went to the Assembly in 2025; no later source confirms parliamentary passage (revision). That is the whole of the record. A regulatory framework sitting with the legislature for a year with nothing published about its progress is the standing condition of most legislative items in this unit.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	A data governance capacity building workshop was held in July 2026 as part of adopting the continental data policy framework nationally. The workshop ran over two days with a European development hub, a continental development agency and a regional civil-society network (workshop). No national policy, adoption decision or timetable follows it. Adoption of the continental framework is at the stage of officials being trained on it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	A personal data protection law of 2016 modelled on a superseded European directive is enforced by the national authority, and the primary text is not held. The enactment year is taken from the law's own designation, and the only source describing it is a 2024 secondary legal survey rather than the 2016 text (law). Modelling on a directive that Europe itself replaced in 2018 is the substantive point: the regime the authority enforces is two generations behind the standard its cooperation partners now work to. The country is a signatory to the continental cyber and data convention, with ratification status not stated (convention).	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	An aggregated identification document law was flagged as urgent by a lender mission in 2025, its absence stated as a potential constraint on data collection, and no later source confirms passage. The mission flagged review, public consultation, finalisation and approval as urgent (law). A year later nothing records movement. The foundational digital identity it would govern has live prototypes and a system integrator engaged, so the build is running ahead of the statute — the same order this frame finds in most units.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	A National Framework for Interoperability was enacted as Law 1/2024 for public-sector data sharing, and only a secondary legal survey describes it. The law is held through the same 2024 legal-survey chapter as the data-protection law, not through its own text (law). It is the legal basis for the civil-registry to electoral-database linkage recorded separately, which is the one working interoperability in this unit — so the law has an evidenced use even though its provisions cannot be read here.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Data protection	Data protection authority	The authority was assigned to supervise the civil-registry to electoral-database interconnection, and signed a cooperation memorandum with a Macau counterpart covering cross-border flows and artificial-intelligence supervision. Supervision of the interconnection was assigned in April 2026, which is the only instance in this base of a data-protection authority being given oversight of a specific interoperability project at the point it goes live (supervision). The memorandum was signed in June 2026 covering cross-border data flows, artificial-intelligence supervision, awareness, training and joint studies (memorandum , pacts). The authority is also a founding member of a recently created Lusophone data-protection network, hosted for a cooperation visit by the Portuguese commission (network). Its supervisory output — findings, penalties, registrations — is not published at any date.	ADVANCED
Data protection	National data protection readiness		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	The country is one of seven covered by a programme for African developing island economies, and takes part in a Lusophone data governance workshop series and regional digital governance dialogues. The island economies programme was launched at a ministerial segment in July 2026; it is a seven-state programme and no national commitments beyond the communique are detailed (programme). A second Lusophone data governance workshop was held in June 2026, and the country's specific national content from it is not detailed (workshop). A second webinar in the regional digital governance series covered digital identity as foundational infrastructure, again from a multi-country source with no national content separated out (dialogues). Three regional forums, and in none of them can the base say what this country said or undertook.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National quality standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	Adoption of international standards		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	A first internet governance forum was held over three days in July 2026, opened by the prime minister. The first edition was convened by the regulator and opened by the head of government (forum). No outcome document, participant count or commitment is published. It is the only multi-stakeholder convening in this ledger, and it is a first edition, so nothing yet establishes whether it becomes a standing channel.	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy		NO EVIDENCE

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation		NO EVIDENCE
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships		NO EVIDENCE
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance		NO EVIDENCE
New investments	Development-partner project financing	A lender digital project had disbursed 36 per cent by September 2025 at a moderately satisfactory rating, and it finances almost everything else in this ledger. The project finances the digital identity, the citizen portal, the interoperability platform, the incident response team and the data-centre work (project , approval). That concentration is the finding: a single donor operation is the delivery vehicle for the state's entire digital programme, and its September 2025 mission report is also the only source for four separate items recorded here. A payment system and financial inclusion grant of about US\$3.34m has been active since 2017 (grant); the disbursed figure in the source exceeds the committed figure with no explanation found (grant).	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	The incumbent operator inaugurated its 35th antenna in March 2026, on a network expansion running alongside a school connectivity plan. The 35th antenna was inaugurated in a coastal district in March 2026 (antenna , expansion). No coverage percentage, subscriber count or population-served figure accompanies it, so the antenna count is the only measure of the network the base holds. For a two-island state, a count of masts is a more meaningful measure than it would be elsewhere, and it is still not coverage.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet usage		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Mobile affordability		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	National fibre backbone		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	A submarine cable to the second island is listed as an active project objective, and no source states its build status or a completion date. It is monitored as an objective of the lender's digital project (cable). No build status or completion date is held. Connecting the smaller island is the single most consequential connectivity item for this country, and the base can say only that it remains an objective.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Satellite internet service was activated in December 2025, about ten months after the operator stated an intention to invest. Intention to invest was reported in February 2025 and service began in December (service , intention). No licence terms, subscriber count, tariff or regulatory condition is published. In an island state whose only submarine cable to its second island is still in build, satellite is the redundancy that arrived first.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	The procurement agency tendered servers and disaster recovery for the digital identity data centre, and the decision is not confirmed. The tender covers servers and a disaster recovery arrangement for the identity data centre, inside a wider government data-centre modernisation (tender , mission). The tender's own body is an attached document that has not been read, so scope, value and specification are unstated. No award or decision is confirmed. That a disaster recovery arrangement is being procured alongside the primary is worth noting: it is the only redundancy design named anywhere in this ledger.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Grid reliability	The procurement agency extended the deadline on a tender for a new management information system for the electricity and water utility. The tender covers supply, installation, training and commissioning; the notice is a scanned document with no text layer and only its headline is readable, so scope and value are unstated (tender). An extended deadline usually indicates insufficient qualifying bids, though nothing on file says so. It is the only utility system in this ledger, and the grid it would manage is the one every data centre and antenna in the country depends on.	ADVANCED
Energy	Rural electrification		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems		NO EVIDENCE
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	An incident response team appears as a lender mission objective — its materialisation to be launched — on a single line in one report with no later source. The mission listed launching the team's materialisation as an objective in September 2025 (team). Nothing since. A single line in one donor mission report is the entire cybersecurity record for this country: no strategy, no statute, no incident, no capability figure appears anywhere else in this ledger.	ADVANCED

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	A foundational digital identity on an open-source platform has live prototypes for credentials, data exchange, portal and electronic signature, and no source confirms the card itself has launched. A system integrator is engaged with the identity institute and the registries directorate, with prototypes live and a roadmap running January to May 2026 (pilot , mission). No source held confirms the foundational card has launched, and the roadmap's delivery is not confirmed either. The identification law that would govern it was flagged as urgent in 2025 and has not passed. So the components exist as prototypes, the statute does not exist, and whether the thing itself is issued is unestablished.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	A free national identity card campaign ran in phases including an islet and a diaspora arm, with cards collectable at the embassy in Portugal. The campaign ran to an outlying islet in January 2026 and extended to the diaspora, with cards collectable at the embassy in Portugal by June (campaign , diaspora , embassy). Free issuance and physical collection at an embassy are the two access designs that matter most in a small island state with a large diaspora, and both are recorded here. No issuance count, coverage figure or campaign end date is published.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	A passport issuance system was launched in April 2026 under a four-year contract with a foreign state mint. The system launched under a four-year contract with another country's national printing and minting house (system). The predecessor system's status is not established in anything held, so what changed is unstated. Passport personalisation held under contract with a foreign state institution is a sovereignty arrangement the record states and does not examine.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The central bank launched a first financial technology sandbox under the national financial inclusion strategy, and no later update is held. The sandbox was launched in June 2025 (sandbox). No cohort, admission, criteria or graduation is recorded since. It is the only payments instrument in this ledger apart from a donor grant active since 2017, so the country's entire digital payments record is a sandbox with no published cohort and a grant with an unexplained disbursement figure.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Population register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Civil register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Address register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Business register	A legal and technical diagnostic of the business registry was presented toward a modern, data-oriented registry, and no later source is found. The diagnostic findings were presented by a lender mission in September 2025 (diagnostic). Nothing since. It is one of four items in this unit whose entire record is a single line in one donor mission report.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Social protection register	The social protection directorate stated a coverage figure for the single social registry and clarified that it is not a poverty count. The clarification was issued in August 2026 (clarification , mission). An agency publicly correcting a misreading of its own registry figure is unusual in this frame and worth recording as such: a registry count measures who is enrolled, not who is poor, and conflating the two misstates both. No enrolment total, update cycle or link to the identity system is published.	ADVANCED
Registries	Electoral register	The automatic electoral roll carries 146,510 voters for the September 2026 elections, added after a process failure that had missed about 1,860 eligible voters. The reform project closed in September 2025, the new system was ready in February 2026 and automatic registration was inaugurated in April (project , system , inauguration). The provisional roll carries 146,510 voters, added after a fix to the process failure (roll). The finding is what the failure was: the first automatic derivation from the civil registry reproduced that register's own omissions. Automating a derivation inherits the source's gaps, and the electoral commission launched a consultation and update campaign in response. The data-protection authority supervises the interconnection, which is recorded separately.	MIXED the first automatic roll derived from the civil registry while that derivation reproduced the register's own omissions
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Land register		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Health		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Education		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	Computing equipment was handed over to the tax directorate in August 2026, with no value or delivery schedule stated. The handover was made with a United Nations development partner (handover). No value for the equipment and no delivery schedule is stated, and no tax system, digitisation programme or revenue objective is named alongside it. Equipment arriving without a stated system is what most of this unit's government-technology record looks like.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	An integrated trade single window and customs system deployment was announced with United Nations support in January 2026. The announcement covers a port and external trade single window alongside a customs platform deployment (announcement). No contract, value, timetable or go-live is published, and nothing has entered the base since. For an island economy dependent on port throughput, it is the highest-value government system announced in this period and the least evidenced.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	A citizen portal entered beta in March 2026, funded by a lender and a foundation with external technical advisory. The beta was launched at the identity institute's eighteenth anniversary (portal , launch). Two accounts frame the same launch differently — one as the institute's portal, the other as the lender and foundation's citizen portal — and they are treated here as one object. No service count, user figure or exit-from-beta date is published. It sits on the same interoperability platform and digital identity prototypes recorded separately, none of which is confirmed delivered.	ADVANCED

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Control of AI abuse		NO EVIDENCE
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production		NO EVIDENCE
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs		NO EVIDENCE
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)		NO EVIDENCE
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	A tender for 80 tablets and 90 desktops for school computer rooms closed in August 2026, under a national digital learning programme, alongside a school connectivity plan announced in 2025. The equipment tender was opened by a United Nations agency and closed on 12 August 2026 (tender , procurement). The operator's school connectivity plan would expand fibre and mobile to schools, larger schools first, working with the education ministry; it predates the window and no follow-up source is found (plan). One hundred and seventy devices is the whole of the country's school digital equipment programme on this record, and the connectivity that would make them useful is an unfollowed announcement.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy		NO EVIDENCE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs		NO EVIDENCE
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides		NO EVIDENCE

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Censuses and surveys		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data		NO EVIDENCE
Open data	Use of open data		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National policy linking digital infrastructure to energy supply	A national policy or programme document connecting power reliability or generation to digital-infrastructure planning.	not yet probed
Compute or high-performance computing capacity	A data-centre, cloud or high-performance computing specification distinct from the GoSTP data-centre tender.	not yet probed
Earth-observation or satellite-data programme	A national earth-observation or geospatial-data programme document.	not yet probed
Dedicated rural digital-service programme	A programme document distinct from the CST school-connectivity plan.	not yet probed
Digitisation of district-administration systems	A district-administration system specification or digitisation programme document.	not yet probed
National technical standards or interoperability framework beyond Law 1/2024	A distinct standards body or technical-specification document.	not yet probed
Open government data portal	A public-sector open-data portal or policy document.	not yet probed
ICT sector size or industry-policy programme	An ICT-sector policy, statistics publication or industry-support programme document.	not yet probed
Indian digital-sector engagement with STP	Any Indian government or vendor financing, contract or memorandum covering STP.	not yet probed
Gulf-state digital investment in STP	Any Gulf-state investment, financing or memorandum covering STP.	not yet probed
Applied digital-research programme	A university, agency or donor-funded applied digital-research programme document.	not yet probed
Financing memorandum distinct from the AfDB/World Bank/ UNICEF instruments already recorded	A separate financing MoU not already captured under finance.new.	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Domestic-state digital-transformation budget line	An STP government budget document or appropriation line for digital transformation.	not yet probed

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.